
READ ONCE

Before you start

APPLIES TO EVERY PROMPT

The rules that apply to every prompt in every chapter: student privacy, what to check before you send, and what never goes into a chat window.

The Teacher AI Toolkit

Works in ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini

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Before you use any prompt in this book

Read this once. It applies to every prompt in every chapter.

THE ONE-MINUTE VERSION

AI writes a **first draft**. You are the teacher. Nothing in this book produces something that goes to a student, a family, or a permanent record without you reading it first.

NEVER PASTE THESE INTO AN AI TOOL

- Student names, initials or ID numbers
- Contact details for students or families
- Medical information, diagnoses, or protected plans
- Confidential incident or child-protection records
- Any story detailed enough to identify one child

Write "**a 5th grade student**" or "**Student A**" instead.

Taking the name out is not the same as making it anonymous. A class of 28 with

one wheelchair user is identifiable without any name at all. If the detail is

what makes the request work, that is exactly the detail to leave out.

Use whatever AI tool your school has approved. If your school has not approved one, ask before putting any school information into any of them.

WHY THE RULE ABOVE IS NOT JUST GOOD MANNERS

Under **FERPA**, a student's education records — and any personally identifiable information taken from them — are protected. A district can share those records with an outside company only under an agreement that binds the company to use the data for the school's purposes and nothing else. A general chat tool you signed up for yourself is not covered by any such agreement.

So the practical line is simple:

THIS IS FINE	THIS IS NOT
"A 5th grade student who reverses digits"	The student's name, initials or ID
"Three anonymous response patterns I saw"	A screenshot of the gradebook
Your own wording of a concern	The text of an IEP, 504 plan or incident report

Your district may also have its own rules that are stricter than FERPA, and an approved-vendor list that is shorter than you expect. Ask once; it takes a minute and it settles the question for the whole year.

If students will use a tool themselves, check their age against the tool's own terms as well — most consumer AI tools set a minimum age, and **COPPA** governs services that collect data from children under 13. That is a district decision, not a classroom one.

This book is written so you never need to cross any of those lines: every prompt works from your description of the situation, not from the record.

WHAT AI MAY WRITE, AND WHAT IT MAY NOT

It may invent: teaching activities, practice questions, worked examples, fictional scenarios, sentence starters, structures and sequences.

It must never invent:

NOT THIS	WHY
What a student said or did	You were there. It wasn't.
Research findings or quotations	It will produce plausible fake citations
Standards, codes, or policy wording	Check the real document
Dates, approvals, meeting records	These are factual records
Test scores or measured results	These are evidence, not text

If something you need is missing, the prompt is written to **ask you** rather than fill the gap. When it asks, answer — do not let it guess.

JUDGMENTS THAT STAY WITH YOU

AI does not decide a final grade, a placement, a disciplinary outcome, or anything to do with child protection. It can help you draft the words. The decision is yours, and so is the responsibility.

Never let it infer a diagnosis, a home situation, a motivation, an identity, or a fixed ability level. It cannot know these, and a confident sentence about them is still a guess.

Keep any accommodation or constraint you supplied. If you said a student has extra time, that must survive into the draft.

TWO HABITS WORTH BUILDING

Check the math and the facts yourself. If you ask the model to check its own work it will say it checked. That is not verification.

Read the draft as the person receiving it. A parent email that reads fine to you at 9pm may not read fine to a family at 8am.

IF A REQUEST TOUCHES HARM OR DANGER

Stop. Do not work it through with an AI tool. Follow your school's mandated-reporting or emergency procedure. That process exists for exactly this moment.

PASTE THIS ONCE, AT THE START OF YOUR CHAT

Instead of repeating rules in every prompt, paste this at the top of a new conversation. Everything after it inherits the rules.

COPY THIS PROMPT

You are helping a classroom teacher draft materials.

Rules for this whole conversation:

- I will not give you any student's name, ID, or identifying details, and you must not ask for them.
- You may invent activities, examples and fictional scenarios. Never invent student observations, research, quotations, standards, policies, dates, approvals or measured results.
- If something essential is missing, ask me. Do not fill the gap yourself.
- Keep any constraint or accommodation I give you.
- Do not infer a diagnosis, home situation, motivation, identity, or fixed ability level.
- Separate what I told you, what you are proposing, and what you are unsure of.
- End each answer with a short list of what I should check before using it.

Confirm you have these, then wait for my first task.

Then paste any prompt from any chapter.